# [HIST-PLC-008] Nungbi (Luireishimphung) Black Stone Pottery Settlement

### Translation / Context: Ancestral Craft Cradle of Wheel-less Serpentinite Pottery

Category: PLACE | Period: Traditional Craft Era | Date: Ancestral Era to Present
Place: Nungbi [Nungbi Khullen] | Dialect: Northern Tangkhul / Raphei
Source: Documented in Horam 1977, Roy 1961, Manipur Cultural Di (1750)
Clearance: Cultural Heritage Documentation | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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**Key Figures: Nungbi Master Potters, Village Council (Hangva), Luireishimphung Clan Elders**

Topography: Nungbi Khullen & Nungbi Kajui, Northern Ukhrul (Elevation 1,550 m)

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Overview: Historic northern settlement celebrated globally for its ancient craft of hand-shaped black stone pottery (Hampai), fashioned without a potter’s wheel from a sacred blend of weathered serpentinite stone and

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### Indigenous Tangkhul Chronicle / Oral Memory:

Nungbi (Luireishimphung) village-hi northern Ukhrul-li wheel-less black
Serpentinite stone kala weathered black clay ngarum-da artisans-na manua
Megalithic lungchei monoliths kala pottery rituals ancestral craftsman t

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### English Translation & Scholarly Interpretation:

Nungbi (Luireishimphung) in northern Ukhrul is the world-renowned ancest
Artisans blend crushed serpentinite rock with weathered alluvial clay, s
The settlement preserves ancient commemorative megaliths (Lungchei) and

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### Chronological Milestones & Key Events:

1. Ancient Era: Discovered by northern Tangkhul pioneers finding unique serpentinite stone outcrops along the river gorge.
2. Craft Evolution: Perfection of the wheel-less shaping technique, polishing with mountain bamboo and river stones.
3. 19th Century: Nungbi cooking pots traded across Manipur, Nagaland, and the Kabaw Valley for iron, salt, and silk.
4. Contemporary: Global recognition and Geographical Indication (GI) registration candidacy for indigenous cultural preservation.

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### Key Tangkhul Historical Terminology:

* Hampai : Traditional wheel-less black stone pottery vessel
* Nungbi : Ancestral settlement name denoting ’rock spring’
* Lungchei : Commemorative upright stone monolith

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